

Signal of the week

EU Data Act Article 3 access-by-design rule bites on connected-vehicle OEMs

From 12 September 2026 all connected products sold in the EU, vehicles included, must be built so users can access their data directly and redirect it to third parties. Compliance vendors including Grape Up's Databoost and Smartcar report several OEMs have integrated in time; laggards now face member-state enforcement.

Why it matters to Cubic³ — Every EU OEM programme now needs an audited data-access path — the orchestration and consent layer we already sell becomes a compliance line item, not a nice-to-have.

Sources: Automotive IQ (2026-09-12) · Grape Up (2026-09-12)

Where the activity was

	SDV	Connect-ivity	AI	Data mgmt	Digital twins
Automotive	6	3	3	3	0
Robotics / AV	4	2	5	2	0
Energy	2	1	2	3	2
Agri / industrial	4	1	5	1	1

Qualifying items this week (score ≥ 6): none 1-2 3-5 6+

The read-across

The week's 18 qualifying items cluster around one theme: the software layer is being locked down by regulators and standardised by consortia at the same moment. UN R156 became mandatory for all new EU vehicles in July, the EU Data Act's Article 3 access-by-design rule bit on 12 September, Germany's MiSpeL V2G framework is now live, and the FCC has added foreign-produced robots to its Covered List. In parallel Nissan-Honda, the four-way European OS group, and Japan's JASPAR are all racing to fix the API surface below the application layer. Six of the qualifying items involve Cubic³ named accounts or direct competitors.

The heat-map shows SDV lit across every domain and connectivity notably thin outside automotive — a gap the Viasat-Space42, Iridium NTN Direct and Onomondo SGP.32 announcements are moving to close. Robotics and agri/industrial are now converging on the same physical-AI, edge-inference and OEM-agnostic autonomy stack (ASI, AIM, Applied Intuition's Dana, Caterpillar-NVIDIA). Energy is where regulation and product finally meet: VW/Elli's Q4 V2G launch, Hyundai's All Day Energy platform and the IEA-recorded Brazil and Korea pilots turn the EV battery into a metered grid asset governed by SDV-grade OTA.

60 items screened | 18 qualified (score ≥ 6) | 6 account-relevant

Automotive OEMs

SDV

Nissan and Honda sign joint agreement to standardise ECUs, in-vehicle OS and middleware

On 31 August 2026 Nissan and Honda formalised a joint development agreement covering the ECUs, vehicle operating system and middleware layers of their next-generation software-defined vehicles. The pact mirrors the parallel Volkswagen, BMW, Mercedes-Benz and Stellantis European OS effort.

Connectivity SDV

Verizon becomes US connectivity provider for BMW vehicles via KDDI global platform

All newly manufactured BMW Group vehicles now use Verizon for US cellular service, routed through KDDI's global connected-vehicle platform, which handles the eSIM profile before hand-off. The arrangement was confirmed in the week of 6 July 2026 by MVNO trade trackers.

So what — Two Cubic³ named accounts are consolidating their software stack; any connectivity or data-access proposal must now clear both companies' shared architecture, not each brand separately.

MarkLines, 2026-08-31 · TT News, 2026-08-31

● Robotics and autonomous vehicles

Connectivity Data mgmt AI

FCC adds foreign-produced advanced robots to national-security Covered List

The FCC's Third Report and Order, adopted in July 2026, adds foreign-produced humanoids, quadrupeds, AMRs and connected service robots to its Covered List, citing a 2026 remote-access vulnerability in consumer robots and a Unitree fleet exploit. Unitree has warned that current and future US sales face approval hurdles.

So what — US robot fleet operators now need a Western-vetted connectivity and data path — a direct opening for our orchestration stack in the humanoid and AMR segments.

K&L Gates, 2026-08-03

So what — A named account is running its eSIM orchestration through a direct Cubic³ competitor; the counter-pitch has to be a like-for-like global platform with better VAS.

Atomic Mobile, 2026-07-06

SDV AI

NHTSA orders Tesla to answer 21 sworn questions on Cybercab self-certification

NHTSA's Special Order AQ26002, issued on 10 September 2026, required Tesla to answer 21 sworn questions on how the steering-wheel-free camera-only Cybercab was self-certified against federal safety standards. Tesla's response deadline fell on 30 September 2026, with civil penalties and a potential stop-sale on the table.

So what — Regulator scrutiny of camera-only autonomy will slow US robotaxi rollouts and re-open the door for connectivity-backed remote supervision and V2X-based safety layers.

NHTSA / Basenor, 2026-09-30

● Energy

SDV Data mgmt

Volkswagen and Elli confirm Q4 2026 launch of integrated V2G package in Germany

Volkswagen and its energy subsidiary Elli will launch a bundled vehicle-to-grid product in Germany in Q4 2026, combining EV, app, electricity tariff, smart meter, bidirectional charger and automated energy-management software. The package sits on Germany's new MiSpeL technical framework.

So what — This is the first commercial V2G bundle from a global OEM — Fleet Wallet has a clean wedge as the bidirectional settlement rail between driver, CPO and utility.

Volkswagen Group Newsroom, 2026-04-16

SDV Data mgmt Connectivity

Germany's MiSpeL V2G technical framework goes live, enabling commercial bidirectional charging

Germany's Bundesnetzagentur MiSpeL framework, which sets the interoperability and metering rails for commercial V2G, entered force in April 2026 following the November 2025 Energy Industry Act amendment removing double grid fees for EV storage. BMW with E.ON and Volkswagen with Elli are the first OEMs launching products on it.

So what — Germany is now the reference V2G market; our metering, identity and settlement layer needs a MiSpeL conformance statement in the next sales pack.

Eleport, 2026-05-07

● Agri and industrial OEMs

SDV AI

Applied Intuition extends 'Dana' agentic-AI SDV workflow to mining, construction and ag OEMs

Applied Intuition published details of Dana, an agentic AI unifying vehicle OS processes, OTA, sensor integration and energy management in one workflow, explicitly extended to mining, construction and agricultural vehicles. The platform aims to compress engineering handoffs across the software lifecycle.

So what — Off-highway OEMs are being handed an automotive-grade SDV toolchain; our connectivity and data-access layer should be pre-integrated with Dana before AGCO or CNH ask.

Applied Intuition, 2026-08-13

AI SDV

Komatsu and AIM Intelligent Machines move autonomous dozers and excavators to commercial deployment

Komatsu, its EARTHBRAIN subsidiary and AIM Intelligent Machines progressed their autonomous bulldozer and hydraulic excavator programme into commercial deployment at US customer jobsites, with a Japan launch planned for 2027. AIM's physical-AI autonomy stack has already been used at fleet scale on dozers.

So what — A Cubic³ named account is scaling autonomy across brownfield fleets — the retrofit connectivity and telemetry pipe is a direct proposal, not a future one.

International Mining, 2026-07-31

What this means for Cubic³

- Position.** Position Cubic³ as the neutral SGP.32 orchestrator now that Onomondo, G+D/Rivian/AT&T and KDDI/Verizon/BMW have set the reference architecture; the differentiator is multi-domain, not just automotive.
- Pipeline.** Re-open the BMW, Honda, Hyundai and AGCO conversations against the specific compliance clocks — UN R156, EU Data Act Article 3, MiSpeL — with a one-page mapping of where our orchestration and data-access layer removes their exposure by Monday.
- Portfolio.** Fleet Wallet has a clean wedge in Germany on the back of VW/Elli's Q4 V2G launch and Hyundai's All Day Energy rollout: bidirectional settlement between driver, CPO and utility is the missing rail. Brief product this week.